

n8n Manager — Detailed User Guide (English)

This document is written step-by-step in plain language so that even people **new to computers, phones, electronics, or IT** can follow it. Technical terms are explained in simple words.

🌐 한국어: [GUIDE.md](#) · 📄 Short overview: [README.en.md](#)

i The tool's on-screen menu is in **Korean**. This guide tells you exactly which key does what, so non-Korean speakers can use it confidently.

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0. How to read this

- **In a hurry?** Just read "Quick Start" in [README.en.md](#).
 - Use this document like a **dictionary you consult when stuck**. You don't need to read it cover to cover.
 - The scrolling text in the black window **looks scary but is normal** — it's just n8n working.
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1. What are n8n and a workflow?

- **n8n**: a tool that automatically connects different internet services.
 - **Workflow**: an **automatic rule** that says "when this happens → do that".
 - Example 1) "When a new Gmail arrives → send a Telegram notification"
 - Example 2) "Every morning at 9 → collect headlines from a news site → save them to Google Sheets"
 - In short, it makes the **computer do repetitive manual work** for you.
 - You build workflows by **connecting visual blocks with lines**, so you don't need to code.
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2. Prerequisites in detail

2-1. A Windows computer

- Windows 10 or 11 works. No special hardware needed.
- About **0.5–1 GB** of free disk space is enough.
- This `.bat` tool is **Windows-only** (it will not run on Mac or phones).

2-2. Internet connection

- **Required for install/update** (programs are downloaded from the internet).
- After install, building automations may need internet depending on the services you connect.

2-3. Node.js

- **Node.js** is the **base program** n8n runs on (n8n runs on top of Node.js).
- **You don't need it ready — this kit installs it for you.**
 - If your PC has `winget` (Windows' auto-installer), it tries an **automatic install**.
 - If not, it opens the **official site (nodejs.org)** and guides you to install it.
- If installing manually: click the big **"LTS"** button on the site, run the downloaded file, and keep pressing **"Next"**.

⚠ **Right after installing Node.js, fully close** any open black window and **re-run** the `.bat`. (This lets Node.js be recognized.)

3. Download & install (step by step)

3-1. Download

1. If you received a **ZIP file**: right-click → **"Extract All"**.
2. Open the extracted folder. You should see `n8n_Manager_One-Click_Install-Run.bat`.
3. Make sure `사용설명서.txt` (the guide) is in the **same folder**.

💡 A folder with a **Korean path** (e.g., Desktop) works fine. If you hit problems, move it to a short English path like `C:\n8n`.

3-2. "Unblock" a file downloaded from the internet (once, if needed)

Windows sometimes locks files received from the internet/messengers for safety.

1. Right-click the `.bat` → **"Properties"**.
2. If you see an **"Unblock"** checkbox at the bottom, **tick it**.
3. Click **"OK"**. (If it isn't there, it's already unlocked — just move on.)

3-3. Install (automatic, recommended)

1. **Double-click** `n8n_Manager_One-Click_Install-Run.bat`.
2. (If a **blue warning** appears on first run → see 3-4 below.)
3. When the Korean menu appears, press `0` once.
4. Follow the on-screen guidance.
 - If Node.js is present → it installs n8n and **launches automatically**.
 - If Node.js is missing → it tries auto-install or opens the install site (see 2-3).
5. You succeeded when you see **"[완료] 설치가 끝났습니다!"** ("Install complete!").

3-4. If the "Windows protected your PC" blue warning appears (first time only)

- The first time you open an internet-downloaded `.bat`, a large blue window (**"Windows protected your PC"**) may appear.
- It does **not** mean a virus — it's Windows checking a file it hasn't seen before.
- How to handle: click **"More info"**, then click the **"Run anyway"** button. → The black window opens normally.
- Usually needed **only the first time**.

3-5. When "Administrator rights" are needed

- If install keeps failing, **right-click the** `.bat` → **"Run as administrator"**.

- Antivirus/security software may block it or delete the `.bat`. Temporarily disable it or add an "exception/allow", then retry.
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4. How to run + every menu 0–9

In the black window, **press one number key** to select instantly (no Enter needed; invalid keys won't register, so it's safe).

[0] First time?

- Does install + run **in one go**. **Most recommended for first-timers**.

[1] Install

- Installs n8n only. (Guides you to Node.js first if missing.)

[2] Update

- Updates the installed n8n to the **latest version**. Needs internet.

[3] Start (port 5678)

- **Starts** n8n. The most-used menu.
- After it starts, the **browser opens automatically**. If not, type `http://localhost:5678`.
- A "**port**" is the **number** n8n uses. The default is **5678**.
- If 5678 is already in use, the screen lets you choose ① **keep 5678** / ② **start on another number (recommended)** / ③ **back to menu**.

[4] Start (custom port)

- Start on a port number you choose (e.g., `8080`).
- If unsure, just press **Enter** — it uses the default 5678.
- Non-numbers or values above 65535 automatically revert to 5678.

[5] Backup / open folder

- [1] Back up now: saves your work as a **dated copy**.
- [2] Open folder: opens the work folder (`.n8n`) in Explorer.
- [3] Go back.

[6] Troubleshoot (auto-check)

- Checks Node.js / npm / n8n / internet at once. (Internet is checked by pinging `8.8.8.8`.)

- Shows a **"what to do next"** recommendation.
- Also saves the result to `n8n_진단결과.txt` (attach it when asking for help).

[7] Uninstall

- [1] Remove program only: your work is **kept**. (Recommended)
- [2] Full delete incl. data: your work is **also erased. Cannot be undone**. (Double-confirmed + backup advised)
- [3] Cancel.

[8] Exit

- Closes this menu window. (If n8n is running, stop it first — see chapter 6.)

[9] View guide

- Opens `사용설명서.txt` from the same folder in Notepad.

5. How to use it (first screen, first workflow)

5-1. First screen — "Set up owner account"

1. When you start n8n with [3], the browser shows a **"Set up owner account"** screen.
2. **Choose your own email and password** and enter them.
 - This account is used **only on your computer**, so any email is fine.
 - But **write it down so you don't forget** (see password-recovery in chapter 10).
3. After creating it, the n8n editor appears. Now you can build automations.

5-2. If a "firewall" window appears

- If a **"Windows Security Alert"** appears, click **"Allow access"** (this allows local communication on your own PC).

5-3. Build your first workflow — a very simple example

1. In the editor, click `+` (new workflow).
2. Pick a starting block (trigger) — e.g., "Manual Trigger".
3. Connect the next block with `+` — e.g., a simple note/notification.
4. Run it once with the **Execute / Test** button at the top.
5. If it works, press **Save**. → Saved automations are stored in the `.n8n` folder.

At first, practice with one "Manual Trigger → simple action". Once comfortable, expand to email/messenger/sheet connections.

6. Stopping / restarting

6-1. Stopping (important)

- While n8n runs, text keeps scrolling in the black window.
- To stop, in **that black window** press **Ctrl + C** together.
- When "종료하시겠습니까(Y/N)?" ("Terminate? Y/N") appears, press **Y** and Enter.

6-2. Can I just close the black window?

- Closing it stops n8n too. It's usually fine, but the **Ctrl + C** method above is cleaner.

6-3. Restarting

- Double-click the **.bat** again → press **[3]**.
- Note: n8n **does not auto-start when you boot the PC**. Start it with **[3]** each time you want to use it.

7. Backup / restore

7-1. Backup (protect your work)

1. Menu **[5]** → **[1]** Back up now.
2. A copy is created at **C:\Users\(\yourname)\n8n_backup_(date)**.
3. Move that folder to a **USB drive or cloud** for extra safety.

7-2. Restore (rolling back a backup)

- The original work folder is **C:\Users\(\yourname)\.n8n**.
- To restore: with n8n stopped, overwrite the **.n8n** folder with the contents of your backup folder.
- (If unsure, keep the backup folder and ask for help rather than deleting anything.)

8. Uninstalling

1. Menu **[7]** Uninstall.

2. Choose one of two:

- [1] **Remove program only** — your work is kept. (Recommended)
- [2] **Full delete incl. data** — your work is also erased and **cannot be recovered**.

3. [2] asks for **confirmation twice** for safety. Always do [5] Backup first.

Note: after "Remove program only", the work folder (`.n8n`) remains. If you reinstall later, you can pick up where you left off.

9. Command reference (what each does)

These are commands the kit runs **for you, internally**. You don't need to type them. This is for reference only.

Command	What it does
<code>npm install -g n8n</code>	Installs n8n.
<code>npm update -g n8n</code>	Updates n8n to the latest.
<code>npm uninstall -g n8n</code>	Removes n8n.
<code>n8n start</code>	Starts n8n on the default port (5678).
<code>n8n start --port=8080</code>	Starts n8n on a chosen port (e.g., 8080).
<code>n8n --version</code>	Shows the installed n8n version.
<code>node --version</code>	Shows the Node.js version.
<code>npm --version</code>	Shows the npm (installer tool) version.
<code>winget install OpenJS.NodeJS.LTS</code>	(When Node.js is missing) auto-installs Node.js.

- **npm** is the **package-install tool** that comes with Node.js.
- **-g** means "install so it can be used across the whole computer".

10. Troubleshooting (by symptom)

Always press menu [6] Troubleshoot first for an auto-check. Below are extra fixes per symptom.

● A "blue warning" appears on first run

- It's the "Windows protected your PC" window — not a virus alert, just a check for a file it hasn't seen before.
- Click "More info" → "Run anyway" and it opens normally. (First time only.)

● Antivirus deletes or blocks the `.bat`

- Security software may be suspicious of a `.bat` it hasn't seen before.
- Briefly turn off the antivirus, or add this file to its "exception/allow" list, then run again.
- If the source is trustworthy, it's safe. (This kit only downloads n8n from the internet to install it.)

● "Node.js is missing / not recognized"

- Press menu `[1]` (or `[0]`) for Node.js guidance.
- If you just installed it, **fully close the black window and re-run**.

● Install keeps failing

1. Check the internet connection.
2. **Run the `.bat` as administrator.**
3. Check whether antivirus/firewall is blocking (disable briefly or allow an exception).
4. Company/school networks may block it. Try on home internet.

● The browser won't open

- Type into the address bar: `http://localhost:5678` (or your custom port).
- Wait 5–10 seconds, then refresh with **F5**.

● "Port already in use"

- n8n may already be running → type `http://localhost:5678`.
- If another program uses it → start on a different number (e.g., 8080) via menu `[4]`.

● "This page can't be reached"

- n8n may still be starting. Wait 5–10 seconds, then **F5**.
- If still failing, check the black window for red text (errors) and attach the `[6]` result file when asking for help.

● I forgot my password

- The n8n account exists **only on your computer**.
- Fix: delete the work folder (`.n8n`) and start n8n again to create a new account.

- ⚠ But **your automations are erased too**. Back up with [5] first if they matter.

● Korean text looks broken (black window)

- This .bat is saved for Korean Windows. **Never open it in Notepad and re-save it** (that breaks the Korean). To read it, use menu [9] or 사용설명서.txt .

● Still not resolved

- Send the n8n_진단결과.txt file from menu [6] and ask for help. (Install failures are usually internet, permissions, or antivirus.)

11. Frequently asked questions (Q&A)

Q. The English/text in the black window is scary. Is something wrong? A. No. It's just n8n working. Leave it as is.

Q. Does it cost money? A. Running n8n **on your own computer is free**. (It's different from n8n's paid cloud service.)

Q. Do I always need internet? A. Needed for **install and update**. While running, it depends on the services you connect.

Q. Is my data (account/work) sent anywhere? A. No. This tool and n8n run **only on your computer**. Your work is stored only in the .n8n folder.

Q. Does n8n auto-start when I boot the PC? A. No. It runs **only when you start it with [3]** (no auto-start at Windows boot).

Q. Can I use it on another computer? A. Yes — install it separately on each PC. To move your work, copy the [5] backup folder into the .n8n location on the new PC.

Q. I want to remove it. A. Press menu [7] . You can keep your work and remove only the program, or delete everything. (Back up with [5] before deleting everything.)

Q. I forgot my password. A. The n8n account is on your computer only, so delete the work folder (.n8n) and create it again. But your automations are erased too, so back up first if they matter.

12. File & document locations

Inside the kit folder (your downloaded folder)

- n8n_Manager_One-Click_Install-Run.bat — main program

- `사용설명서.txt` — short Korean guide (opened by [9])
- `README.md` / `README.en.md` — overview (KR / EN)
- `GUIDE.md` / `GUIDE.en.md` — detailed guide (KR / EN, this document)
- `README.pdf` / `README.en.pdf` / `GUIDE.pdf` / `GUIDE.en.pdf` — PDF versions (identical content)
- `LICENSE` — this kit's license (Apache-2.0)
- `NOTICE` — copyright, trademark, non-affiliation notice

Locations n8n creates automatically

- `C:\Users\<yourname>\.n8n` — **your work storage** (most important)
- `C:\Users\<yourname>\n8n_backup_(date)` — [5] backup copies
- `(kit folder)\n8n_진단결과.txt` — [6] check result

13. License · Copyright · Commercial use

 There are two different licenses. Always verify before any commercial use.

13-1. This kit's license

- The kit's original files are under **Apache License 2.0** ([LICENSE](#)).
- Copyright: **Copyright 2026 SoDam AI Studio** ([NOTICE](#)).
- Free to use/modify/redistribute, but you must **keep the copyright notice and LICENSE/NOTICE** (and **state changes** if you distribute a modified version).

13-2. n8n's own license (★ important)

- This kit only **downloads and installs n8n from npm**; it does not bundle/redistribute n8n.
- **n8n = Sustainable Use License (fair-code)** — **NOT standard OSI open source**. Some components may be covered by the separate **n8n Enterprise License**.
- **Allowed:** personal use, **internal business use**, self-hosting, viewing/modifying source.
- **Restricted (commercial resale):**
 - Selling n8n **as a service** to third parties
 - Offering n8n under a **different name (white-label)**
 - **Redistributing n8n as the back-end** of a commercial product
- Such commercial uses require **n8n's separate permission / an Enterprise License**.
- Official sources (**verify directly** before any commercial use — terms may change):
 - <https://docs.n8n.io/sustainable-use-license/>
 - <https://github.com/n8n-io/n8n/blob/master/LICENSE.md>
 - <https://n8n.io/pricing/>

13-3. Trademark

- "n8n" is a trademark of **n8n GmbH**; "Node.js" of the OpenJS Foundation; "Windows" of Microsoft. This kit is an **unofficial helper with no official, affiliate, or sponsorship relationship** ([NOTICE](#)).

 **Plain:** Using it yourself / for your company internally is OK. Selling n8n to others or under another brand needs n8n's permission.

14. Safety & disclaimer

- This kit is provided **"as-is" with no warranty**. You are **solely responsible** for the results of using it.
- It runs **only on your own computer** and does not send your data anywhere.
- **Passwords and your work are your responsibility**. Back up important work with `[5]`, and always back up before `[7]` full delete.
- Never run a `.bat` sent by someone you don't trust.
- Privacy: your n8n account info (email/password) is stored **only in the local `.n8n` folder** on your computer. Nothing is sent externally.

The content of this document (GUIDE.en.md) and GUIDE.en.pdf is identical. The PDF is generated directly from this .md file.